

University of Michigan

Fall 2025 Midterm Instructor Report

EECS 110-001: Discover CS

Madelyn Gatchel

20 out of 31 students responded to this midterm evaluation.

Responses to questions related to the course:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Median
I am learning a great deal in this course. (Q966)	9	9	2	0	0	0	4.39

Responses to questions related to the instructor:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Median
Madelyn Gatchel is enthusiastic. (Q114)	18	2	0	0	0	0	4.94
Overall, this is an excellent course. (Q964)	10	9	1	0	0	0	4.50
Overall, Madelyn Gatchel is an excellent teacher. (Q965)	15	5	0	0	0	0	4.83
Madelyn Gatchel acknowledges all questions insofar as possible. (Q968)	15	5	0	0	0	0	4.83
Madelyn Gatchel uses techniques to foster class participation. (Q972)	12	5	3	0	0	0	4.67
Madelyn Gatchel is willing to meet and help students outside class. (Q975)	16	4	0	0	0	0	4.88
Madelyn Gatchel keeps students informed of their progress. (Q977)	15	5	0	0	0	0	4.83

Written Comments

What are the major strengths of this class? What is helping you to learn? (Q979)

Comments
This is the best class ever for coding beginners
This computer science class' strength is that it makes sure that the student fully understand the work going. This class has helped me work on codes I have never done before with my teammates.
Great pacing, and exercises during lecture really help to digest the content and learn better.
the office hours right after class are super helpful
The lecture collabs are really helpful because they force you to practice what you're learning immediately. They are also beneficial to look back on during lab or homework assignments.
I really enjoy how this class specifically breaks down what each line of code is doing. Madelyn makes sure to explain the code in terms of what Python is thinking when it is reading it, and I find this to be very helpful. Also, this class is doing a great job at showing us the basics of Python while still showing us what people really do with computer science (such as with the student panel).
Madelyn and the IA are both incredibly approachable, and her engaging style of teaching always makes class fun!
I guess a major strength in this class has to deal with how easy it is to get assistance during labs as well as the collaborative aspect. The ability to bounce ideas off of one another is very helpful as it's easier to learn in a group.
Her enthusiasm about the topic the course goes over, and her explaining everything in depth once to the class, then walking around to see if anyone has any more specific questions regarding the code they've created.
I would say the classes biggest strength is that it is very collaborative. Many assignments to allow students to help each other understand the material. The class is helping us to learn how to code at a beginner level.
I think Madelyn is the major strength to this course. She is clearly very excited about CS and the principles we are learning and makes very simple and sometimes boring (at least to me) more exciting. I personally don't like python, but she makes the course something I look forward to despite my dislike for the programming language that we work in.
collaboration, being to freely ask questions, willingness and thoroughness to walk through concepts as we try to complete labs and assignments, and the check in on team assignments and ability to provided partner preferences.
I love the half lecture half lab portion. The split allows me to apply what I just learned on lab.
I love the professor's kindness and patience.
The availability of the instructors is amazing and is very comforting knowing that they are always there to help. Being able to do the labs in class is helpful as well.
Office hours are very helpful to me
The lab section is very helpful. We get to practice what we just learned in the lecture and the lecture slides themselves are extremely helpful when we might have questions or get stuck.

How can Madelyn Gatchel improve this class? If possible, give specific examples. (Q980)

Comments
Perhaps the pace of her lecturer could be slower
On some modules, could there be times where we can further work on what's happening in the practice problems?
N/A
referencing in the homeworks and labs which slides in the lecture it corresponds to. We cover alot in the lecture portions and sometimes I get lost on what concept I should be using while coding in the lab so having like (slide ____) next to the directions for a reference would be REALLY helpful just to help process what skills we are using
Sometimes the lectures feel a bit fast-paced, especially during more complicated (relative) concepts.
I think this class can be improved by giving students just a little bit more time to work on the lecture examples.
I think that everything is overall pretty good in this class, one small thing would be that sometimes I do get a bit tired from a 2 hour class, and maybe a short break in the middle of class would refresh students to continue working through the second half.
Personally, I believe that there should be more time for labs compared to the lecture-ish part of the class. I believe this would give students more time to experiment with code and to ask questions which would help with the hands-on learning aspect on coding.
I have no notes.
I would say that the lecture examples are a little too easy compared to what shows up on the labs and homeworks. After the lecture it feels like everything makes sense as what we did seemed super straightforward but when moving on to the other assignments it feels easy to get lost.
As someone that is someone logical and tech-savvy (ish) I just think that the class is slow and could be faster. However, I recognize that I probably just took the wrong course and that some people in the class require the slower pacing.
Most of the lessons are fairly easy to grasp, but some, like the one covered in Lab 5, were harder to understand. For Lab 5, I found it difficult to follow and figure out which variable I was returning, referring back to, recalling, as well as the syntax, such as which indentation level the print line should be on. These were some of the things I struggled with in homework 3.
I think this class is excellent.
Perfect
The lecture slide presentation is quite fast and it is hard to follow/retain all the info.
N/A
As of right now I'd say there isn't anything major that requires improvement.

Please enter any additional comments you have for Madelyn Gatchel. (Q981)

Comments
Madelyn is a great teacher for computer science and helps the students very well in class and office hours.
N/A
I think I really benefit from how you have us talk you through our ideas for the code, and I appreciate how accessible you are when students need help both in and outside of class.
N/A
The class has been really informative so far and everything has been explained really clearly! Great intro class overall that can easily get people interested in a possible major in CS.
Overall, I like the class and I am glad that I chose this class to be my introduction to coding.
None.
N/A